

Predictive Degradation and Failure Detection Intelligence System

(Ms. Shaista Khanam, Assistant Professor in Electronics and Telecommunication Engineering,
Vidhyavardhini College of Engineering and Technology)

Sanchit Sanjay Gaikwad

*Department of Electronics and Telecommunication
Vidhyavardhini College of Engineering and Technology
Mumbai 4010202, India*

Email id: -sanchit.2400111102@vcet.edu.in

Aditya Anant Ghanekar

*Department of Electronics and Telecommunication
Vidhyavardhini College of Engineering and Technology
Mumbai 4010202, India*

Email id: -aditya.2400121105@vcet.edu.in

Omkar Devrao Hambire

*Department of Electronics and Telecommunication
Vidhyavardhini College of Engineering and Technology
Mumbai 4010202, India*

Email id: -omkar.240016110@vcet.edu.in

Mehul Pravin Hingu

*Department of Electronics and Telecommunication
Vidhyavardhini College of Engineering and Technology
Mumbai 4010202, India*

Email id: -mehul.2400171101@vcet.edu.in

ABSTRACT — In many industries, machines are the backbone of daily operations, and an unexpected breakdown can halt production, cause financial losses, and even pose safety risks. Traditional maintenance practices, such as routine checks or reactive repairs, often fail to catch problems before they escalate, while advanced predictive systems tend to be costly and inaccessible. To bridge this gap, we developed a practical monitoring solution that continuously observes critical indicators like vibration, temperature, acoustic signals, and current, analysing them in real time to identify abnormal behaviour. When irregularities are detected, the system issues immediate alerts through a display and buzzer, enabling timely intervention and predictive maintenance. Demonstrated on an electric motor, this approach proved effective in detecting faults early, offering an affordable and reliable way to reduce downtime and prevent failures.

Keywords— Failure Prediction , Machine Health Monitoring, Multi-Sensor Data Fusion , Predictive Maintenance , Real-Time Monitoring , Trend Analysis , Weighted Health Scoring

I. INTRODUCTION

In modern industrial settings, machinery is the backbone of productivity, and any unexpected failure can bring operations to a standstill. Such breakdowns not only cause costly downtime but also increase maintenance expenses

and pose safety risks to workers. Conventional strategies like repairing machines after failure or performing scheduled servicing often fall short, as they either respond too late or lead to unnecessary part replacements. Without continuous monitoring, early signs of degradation—such as abnormal vibration, overheating, electrical fluctuations, or unusual acoustic signals—often go unnoticed, making it difficult to prevent failures before they occur.

Over the years, several approaches have been introduced to improve machine health monitoring. Some rely on single-parameter tracking, such as vibration or temperature analysis, which limits their ability to detect complex faults. More advanced systems employ machine learning and signal processing techniques, but these often demand costly sensors, high computational resources, and large datasets for training. While effective in certain contexts, such solutions are not always practical for small-scale industries, as they lack affordability, real-time visualization, and user-friendly interfaces. This leaves a gap for a system that is both reliable and accessible.

To address this challenge, we propose a cost-effective, real-time monitoring system that integrates multiple parameters—vibration, temperature, acoustic signals, and current consumption—into a unified framework. By continuously analysing these indicators, the system can detect abnormal conditions early and provide instant alerts

through a display and buzzer, enabling timely intervention. Tested on an electric motor, the solution demonstrated its effectiveness in identifying fault conditions, offering a practical approach to predictive maintenance that reduces downtime, prevents failures, and ensures safer, more efficient industrial operations.

II. LITERAURE SURVEY

Title of Paper	Year	Key Findings & Gaps
<i>IoT-Based Machine Health Monitoring System Using Vibration Analysis</i>	2019	Findings: Real-time vibration monitoring improves early fault detection. Gaps: Limited multi-sensor integration (only vibration used), lacks comprehensive health scoring.
<i>Predictive Maintenance of Industrial Motors Using Machine Learning</i>	2020	Findings: ML models (SVM, ANN) can predict failures with high accuracy. Gaps: Requires large datasets, not suitable for low-cost Arduino-based systems.
<i>Smart Motor Condition Monitoring Using IoT Sensors</i>	2021	Findings: Combines temperature and current sensors for basic health tracking. Gaps: No sound or vibration analysis, lacks real-time visualization dashboard.
<i>Fault Detection in Rotating Machinery Using Acoustic Signals</i>	2018	Findings: Sound (acoustic) signals can detect early-stage faults. Gaps: Highly sensitive to environmental noise, no sensor fusion approach.
<i>Real-Time Industrial Equipment Monitoring System Using Arduino</i>	2022	Findings: Low-cost Arduino systems can monitor multiple parameters. Gaps: No predictive intelligence, only threshold-based alerts.
<i>Multi-Sensor Data Fusion for Machine Health Monitoring</i>	2021	Findings: Combining vibration, temperature, and current improves accuracy. Gaps: Complex implementation, lacks simple UI for interpretation.

Title of Paper	Year	Key Findings & Gaps
<i>Deep Learning-Based Predictive Maintenance in Industry 4.0</i>	2023	Findings: Deep learning enhances prediction of complex failures. Gaps: High computational cost, not feasible for embedded systems.
<i>Condition Monitoring of Electric Motors Using Current Signature Analysis</i>	2017	Findings: Current variations indicate internal motor faults. Gaps: Cannot detect mechanical faults like imbalance or vibration.
<i>Edge Computing for Smart Manufacturing Systems</i>	2022	Findings: Edge devices enable faster decision-making. Gaps: Requires advanced hardware, increases system complexity.
<i>Integrated Dashboard for Industrial Health Monitoring Systems</i>	2024	Findings: Visualization dashboards improve operator decision-making. Gaps: Lack of explainable health scoring and alert reasoning.

III.METHODOLOGY

A. Theory

The proposed Machine Health Monitoring and Failure Prediction System is based on the principle of multi-sensor data fusion and real-time condition monitoring. The system continuously acquires data from multiple sensors measuring temperature, vibration, current, and sound, which are key indicators of machine health.

Each parameter reflects a specific type of fault:

- Temperature indicates overheating and thermal stress
- Vibration represents mechanical imbalance or misalignment
- Current reflects electrical load and abnormalities
- Sound captures acoustic anomalies due to wear or defects

The collected data is processed and normalized to evaluate deviations from normal operating conditions. A weighted health scoring algorithm is used to compute the overall machine health based on the contribution of each parameter.

To predict future failures, the system uses **Linear Regression** to analyze trends in sensor data. By calculating the rate of change of parameters over time, the system estimates how quickly a parameter is approaching its threshold. This allows the prediction of potential failures before they occur.

B. Block diagram

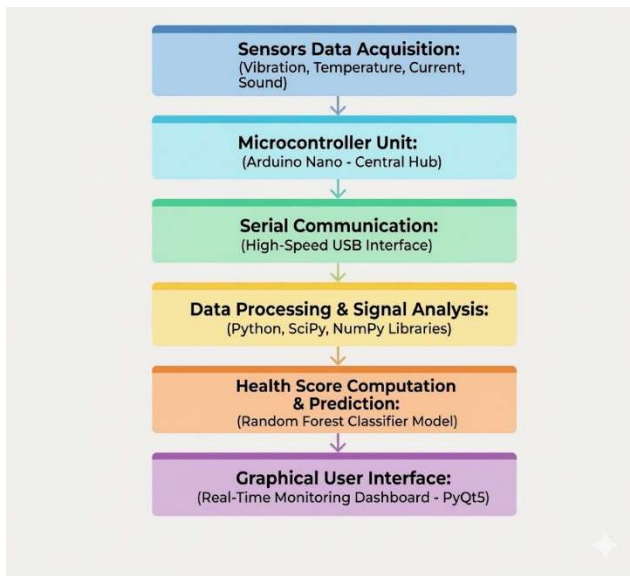


Fig-1

C. Explanation

The system operation can be explained step-by-step:

- 1. Data-Acquisition:**
Sensors continuously measure machine parameters and send analog/digital signals to the microcontroller.
- 2. Data-Transmission:**
The microcontroller processes raw sensor data and transmits it to the computer via serial communication.
- 3. Data-Processing:**
The received data is filtered, stored, and analyzed in real time using Python-based software. A rolling buffer is used to maintain recent data for trend analysis.
- 4. Health-Evaluation:**
A weighted algorithm calculates the machine health score (0–100) by comparing sensor values with predefined thresholds.
- 5. Alert-Generation:**
If any parameter exceeds its threshold, alerts are triggered and displayed in the interface.
- 6. Failure-Prediction:**
Using trend analysis, the system estimates the time remaining before a parameter reaches a critical limit.
- 7. Visualization:**
A graphical interface developed using Tkinter displays real-time values, charts, alerts, and predictions for easy monitoring.

IV.IMPLEMENATION

A. Explanation:

- 1. Sensor Setup:**
All sensors are interfaced with the Arduino Nano. The DHT11 measures temperature and humidity, the MPU6050 captures vibration data, the ACS712 monitors current flow, and the sound sensor detects acoustic variations.

- 2. Signal-Acquisition:**
Each sensor provides either analog or digital signals, which are read by the microcontroller. The Arduino converts these readings into usable values.
- 3. Data-Transmission:**
The microcontroller sends formatted sensor data to the computer via serial communication at a defined baud rate.
- 4. Processing and Analysis:**
The received data is processed using Python. Libraries such as NumPy and SciPy are used for numerical analysis and trend detection using Linear Regression.
- 5. Visualization:**
A graphical interface built using Tkinter displays real-time sensor data, health score, alerts, and predictions.

B. Features

The Purposed system provides the following key provided of Fig-2 is:

Real-Time Monitoring: Continuous tracking of Temperature, vibration, current, and sound

- Health Score Calculation: Dynamic evaluation of machine condition (0–100 scale)
- Alert System: Immediate alerts when parameters exceed thresholds
- Failure Prediction: Estimation of time-to-failure based on trends
- Data Logging: Storage of sensor data in CSV format for analysis
- User Interface: Interactive GUI with charts, gauges, and indicators

Fault Simulation Compatibility: Supports testing using controlled fault injection

C. Components Used

The system is built using the following components:

- Microcontroller: Arduino Nano
- Temperature Sensor: DHT11
- Vibration Sensor: MPU6050
- Current Sensor: ACS712
- Sound Sensor Module: Analog microphone module
- Actuator: 12V DC motor
- Power Supply: 12V–17V DC adapter
- Voltage Regulation: Buck converter or resistor based drop (for testing)
- Communication: USB serial interface
- Software Tools: Python, NumPy, SciPy, TKINTER

VIII. FUTURE SCOPE

Here are some additional points you can include to strengthen your system's future scope and enhancements:

- **Integration of AI-driven anomaly detection** using deep learning (CNN, LSTM) for complex fault patterns.
- **Digital twin technology** to simulate machine behavior and compare real-time performance.
- **Adaptive thresholding** that adjusts limits dynamically based on operating history.
- **Predictive maintenance scheduling** linked with ERP/CMMS systems for automated work orders.
- **Energy efficiency monitoring** to optimize power usage and reduce operational costs.
- **Cybersecurity measures** for protecting IoT-connected devices and data streams.
- **Cross-platform compatibility** with industrial protocols (Modbus, OPC-UA, MQTT).
- **Augmented reality (AR) dashboards** for immersive visualization of machine health.
- **Self-learning models** that continuously improve prediction accuracy with new data.
- **Integration with robotics/automation systems** for autonomous corrective actions.

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